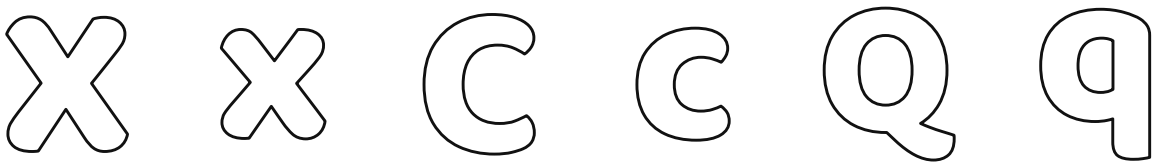
ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 69

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Xhosa Alphabet

Oonobumba besiXhosa

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 34 Xhosa Letters with English Phonetics



Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

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My First Xhosa Alphabet — Oonobumba besiXhosa
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 69

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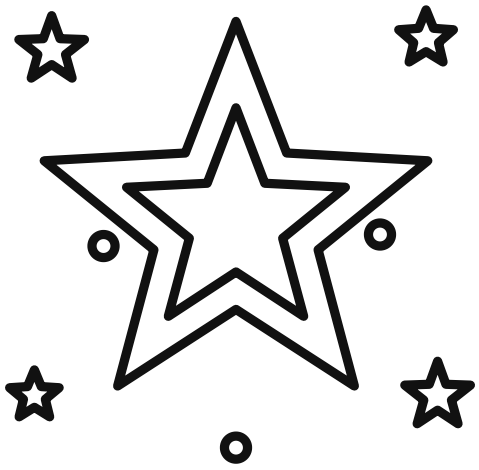
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Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

Fonts: Baloo 2, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License. **Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



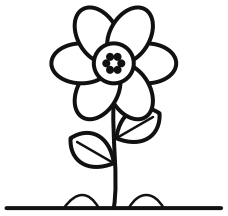
This book belongs to

Le ncwadi yeka

I started learning Xhosa on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 69 is Xhosa. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **CAPITALS** show the stressed syllable: in Xhosa it is nearly always the second-to-last one, *ee-[q]AHN-dah*.
- **[c] [q] [x]** mean: make that **click** (see "Three clicks" before the letter pages).
- **hl** is a hissing 'l' and **dl** a buzzing 'l'; in the pronunciation, **t**, **k** and **p** are never 'th' or 'f'.
- **ee** says 'ee' as in "see", **oo** says 'oo' as in "moon", **oh** says 'o' as in "go", **eh** says 'e' as in "bed".

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Xhosa name** written in Xhosa (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Xhosa letter name · syllables* shows how Xhosa children say the letter (B is «ba», C is «ca»…) and its row of syllables, the way they learn to read.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Standard written Xhosa.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Xhosa! isiXhosa

ee-see-[x]OH-sah — the Xhosa word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **19 million people** speak isiXhosa, at home or as a second language.[3]

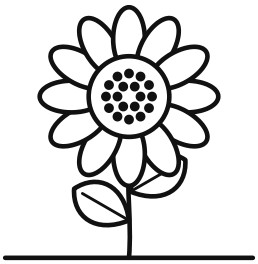
Where?
Mostly in **South Africa**, especially in the **Eastern Cape** and the **Western Cape**, around East London, Gqeberha and Cape Town.

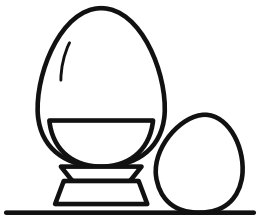
How is it written?
In the **Latin alphabet**, from **left to right**.

How many letters?
26 letters, plus many letter pairs such as **hl**, **dl**, **ty** and **xh**.

Clicks!
C, **Q** and **X** are **click sounds** — and the name **Xhosa** itself starts with a click!

Did you know?
isiXhosa and isiZulu are close cousins: *amanzi* means **water** and *ilanga* means **sun** in both!







The Xhosa Alphabet oonobumba

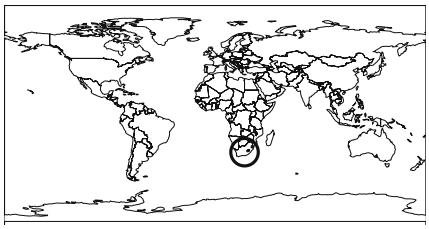
26 letters — oonobumba

Aa *ah*	**Bb** *bah*	**Cc** *[c]ah*	**Dd** *dah*	**Ee** *eh*	**Ff** *fah*	**Gg** *gah*
Hh *hah*	**Ii** *ee*	**Jj** *jah*	**Kk** *kah*	**Ll** *lah*	**Mm** *mah*	**Nn** *nah*
Oo *oh*	**Pp** *pah*	**Qq** *[q]ah*	**Rr** *rah*	**Ss** *sah*	**Tt** *tah*	**Uu** *oo*
Vv *vah*	**Ww** *wah*	**Xx** *[x]ah*	**Yy** *yah*	**Zz** *zah*		

8 letter pairs — bh · dl · hl · kh · ny · ph · th · ty

Bh bh *bah*	**Dl dl** *dlah*	**Hl hl** *hlah*	**Kh kh** *kah*
Ny ny *nyah*	**Ph ph** *pah*	**Th th** *tah*	**Ty ty** *tyah*

Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows southern Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Xhosa spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the oceans **blue**. **Find it:** the dashed line shows where most Xhosa speakers live, around East London, Gqeberha, Mthatha and Komani; many families also live in Cape Town.

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The Letters oonobumba

oh-noh-BOOM-bah — “the letters”

isiXhosa uses the same **26 letters** as English. A few of them make very different sounds!

Three clicks: C · Q · X
C — the “tsk-tsk” click: pull your tongue tip back from your top teeth.
Q — the “pop” click: pop your tongue off the roof of your mouth, like a cork.
X — the side click: click the side of your tongue, like calling a horse. You hear it in the name **Xhosa**!
In the sound guides, **[c] [q] [x]** mean: make the click!

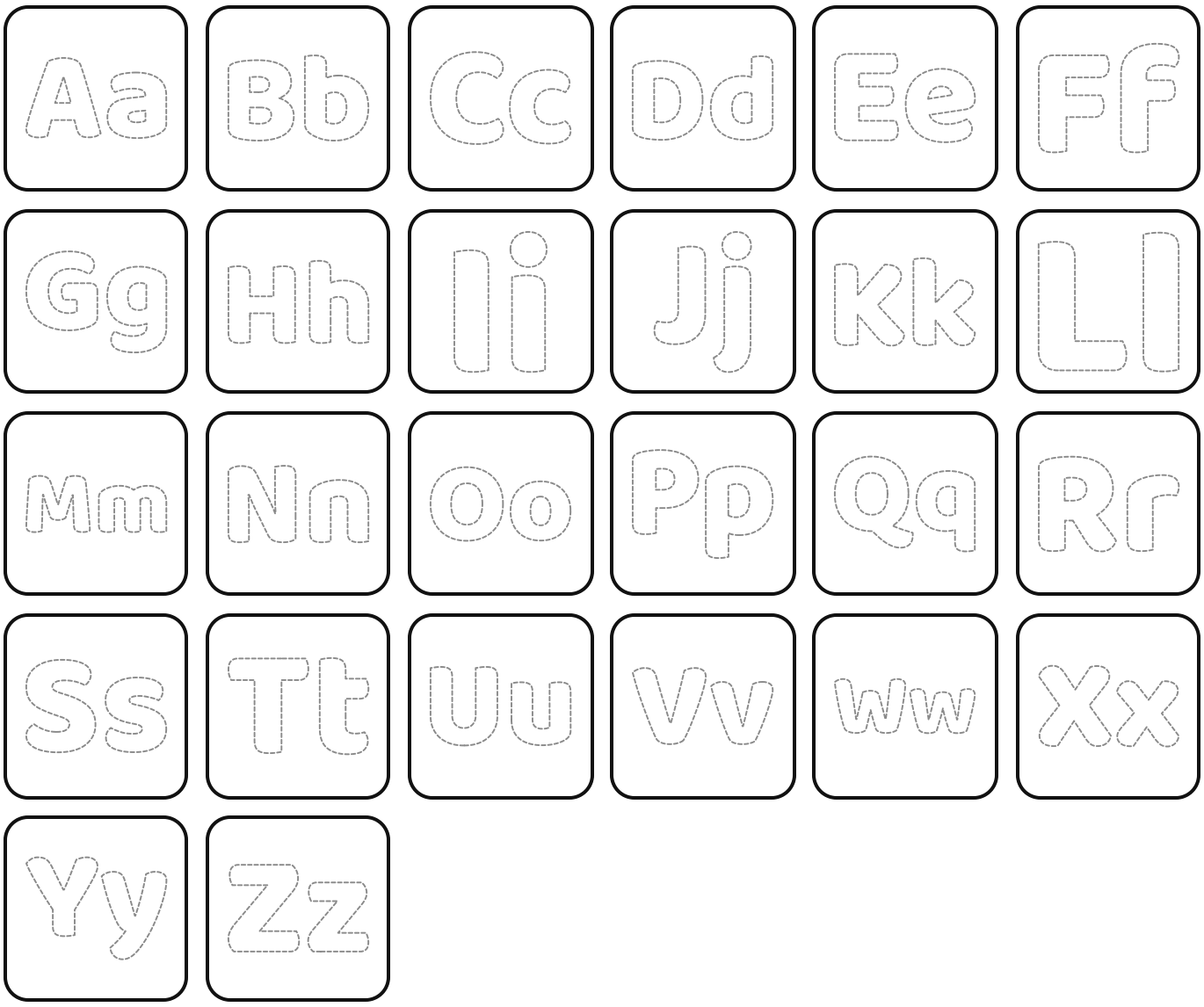
Look past the prefix
Xhosa words begin with a small part such as **i-**, **u-**, **isi-** or **um-**: *i*-qanda (egg), *i*-cephe (spoon). The letter you are learning is underlined in each word.

Ba, be, bi, bo, bu
Every Xhosa syllable ends in a vowel. Every page shows the letter’s row: *ba · be · bi · bo · bu*. Say it like a song!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters oonobumba

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Aa

NAME · IGAMA

a

ah

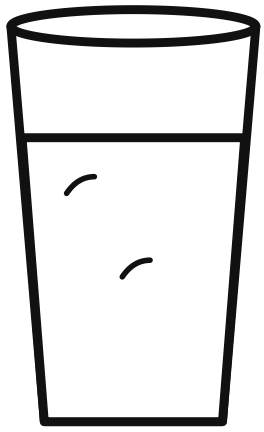
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

A a — «a»

ba · da · ka · la · ma



AA **IS FOR**

amanzi

ah-MAHN-zee

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Aa Aa Aa Aa

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Bb

NAME · IGAMA

ba

bah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘b’, said while breathing in a little

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

B b — «ba»

ba · be · bi · bo · bu

B on its own is a soft, ‘swallowed’ b. **BH** is the ordinary ‘b’ of English.



BB IS FOR

ubisi

oo-BEE-see

milk

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Bb Bb Bb Bb

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Cc

NAME · IGAMA

ca

[c]ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

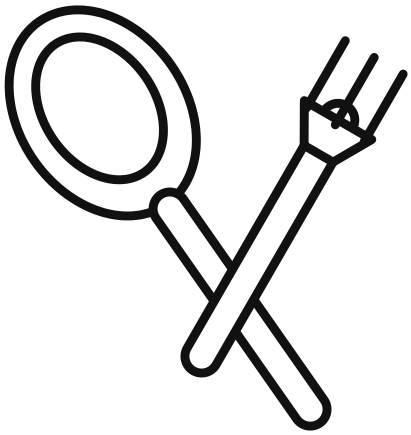
a **click**! Pull the tip of your tongue back from your top teeth: “tsk!”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

C c — «ca»

ca · ce · ci · co · cu

The **tsk-tsk** click, like saying “what a pity!”



CC IS FOR

icephe

ee-[c]EH-peh

spoon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Cc Cc Cc Cc

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Dd

NAME · IGAMA

da

dah

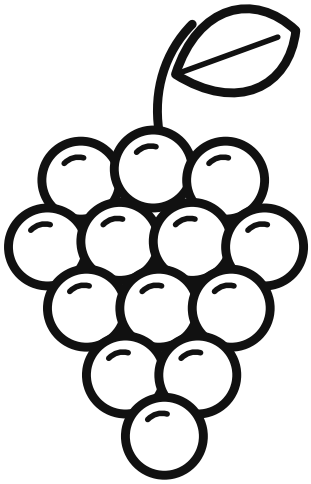
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “dog”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

D d — «da»

da · de · di · do · du



DD IS FOR

iidiliya

ee-dee-LEE-yah

grapes

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Dd Dd Dd Dd

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Ee

NAME · IGAMA

e

eh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

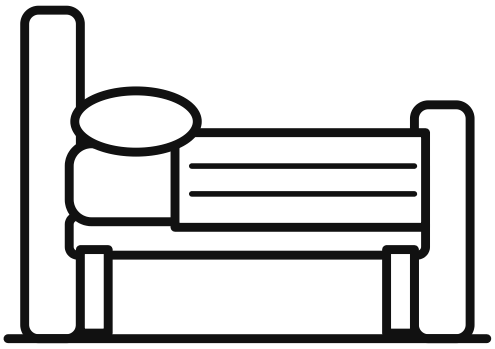
‘e’ as in “bed”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

E e — «e»

be · de · ke · le · me

Xhosa words hardly ever start with E. Find it inside *ibhedi*!



EE IS FOR

ibhedi

ee-BEH-dee

bed

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ee Ee Ee Ee

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Ff

NAME · IGAMA

fa

fah

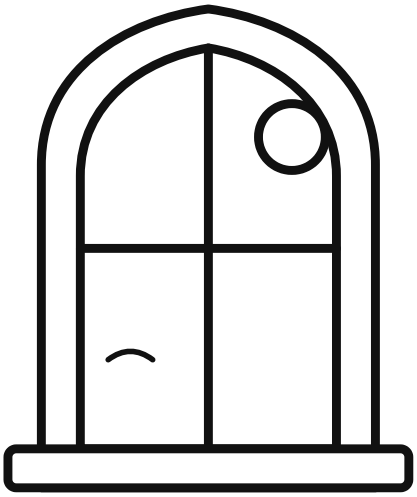
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

F f — «fa»

fa · fe · fi · fo · fu



FF IS FOR

ifestile

ee-fes-TEE-leh

window

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ff Ff Ff Ff

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Gg

NAME · IGAMA

ga

gah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

G g — «ga»

ga · ge · gi · go · gu



GG IS FOR

igubu

ee-GOO-boo

drum

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Gg Gg Gg Gg

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Hh

NAME · IGAMA

ha

hah

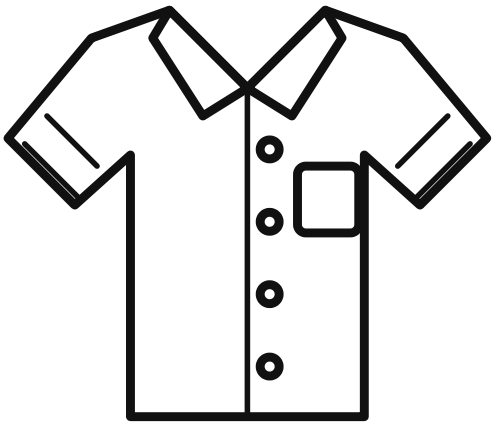
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

H h — «ha»

ha · he · hi · ho · hu



HH IS FOR

ihempe

ee-HEM-peh

shirt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Hh Hh Hh Hh

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Ii

NAME · IGAMA

i

ee

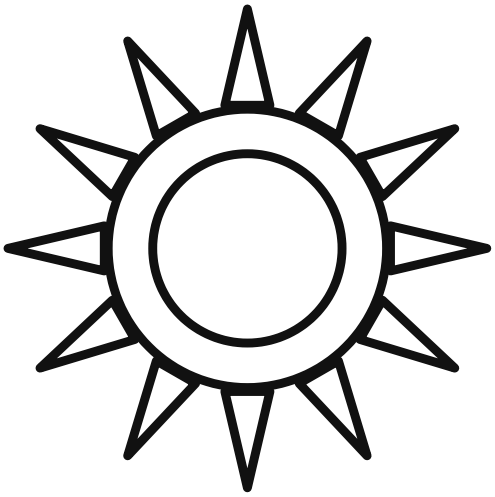
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ee’ as in “see”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

| i — «i»

bi · di · ki · li · mi



Ii IS FOR

ilanga

ee-LAHN-gah

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

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Jj

NAME · IGAMA

ja

jah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

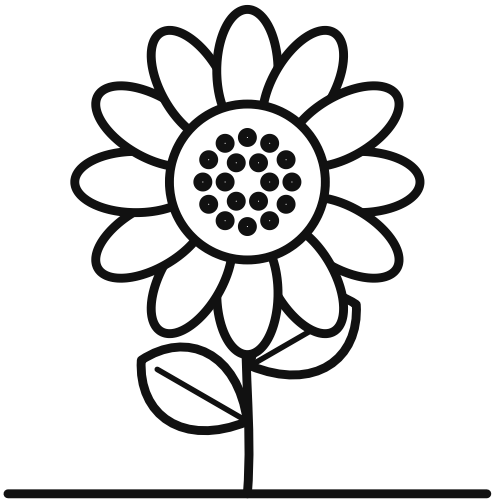
'j' as in "jam"

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

J j — «ja»

ja · je · ji · jo · ju

ujongilanga means "the one that looks at the sun"!



JJ IS FOR

ujongilanga

oo-jon-gee-LAHN-gah

sunflower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Jj Jj Jj Jj

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Kk

NAME · IGAMA

ka

kah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘k’ (no puff of air)

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

K k — «ka»

ka · ke · ki · ko · ku

K is soft; **KH** is a ‘k’ with a puff of air.



KK IS FOR

ikomityi

ee-koh-MEE-tyee

cup

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Kk Kk Kk Kk

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Ll

NAME · IGAMA

la

lah

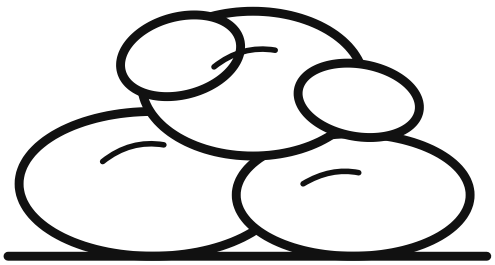
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

L l — «la»

la · le · li · lo · lu



LL IS FOR

ilitye

ee-LEE-tyeh

stone

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ll Ll Ll Ll Ll

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Mm

NAME · IGAMA

ma

mah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

M m — «ma»

ma · me · mi · mo · mu



MM IS FOR

umlilo

oom-LEE-loh

fire

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Mm Mm Mm Mm

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Nn

NAME · IGAMA

na

nah

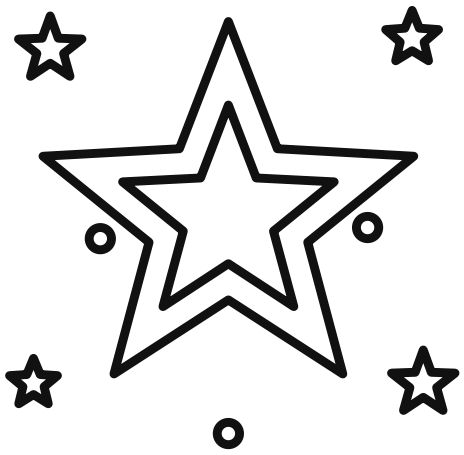
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

N n — «na»

na · ne · ni · no · nu



NN IS FOR

inkwenkwezi

een-kwen-KWEH-zee

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Nn Nn Nn Nn

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Oo

NAME · IGAMA

o

oh

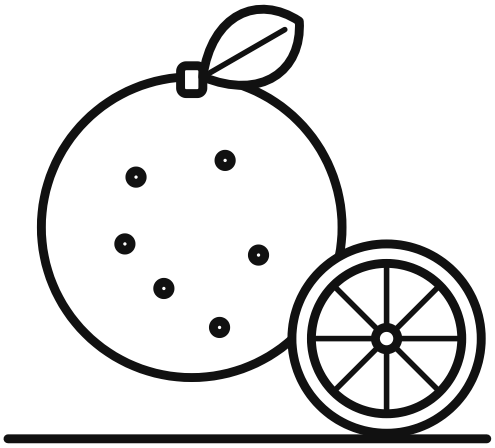
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “for” (short and pure)

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

O o — «o»

bo · do · ko · lo · mo



OO IS FOR

iorenji

ee-oh-REN-jee

orange

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Oo Oo Oo Oo

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Pp

NAME · IGAMA

pa

pah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

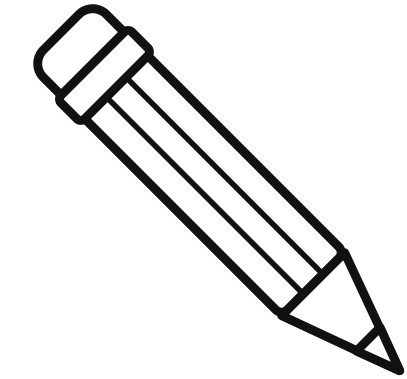
a soft ‘p’ (no puff of air)

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

P p — «pa»

pa · pe · pi · po · pu

P is soft; **PH** is a ‘p’ with a puff of air.



PP IS FOR

ipensile

ee-pen-SEE-leh

pencil

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Pp Pp Pp Pp

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Qq

NAME · IGAMA

qa

[q]ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

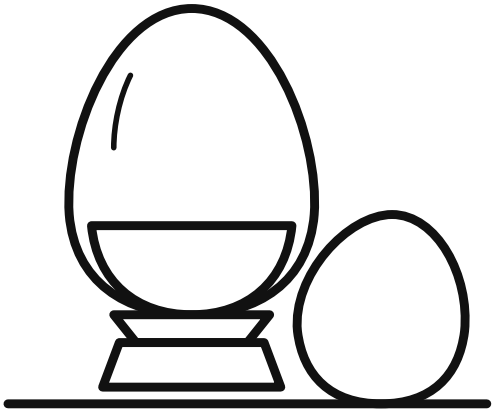
a **click**! Pop your tongue off the roof of your mouth, like a cork

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Q q — «qa»

qa · qe · qi · qo · qu

The loud **pop** click, like a bottle opening.



QQ IS FOR

iqanda

ee-[q]AHN-dah

egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Qq Qq Qq Qq

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Rr

NAME · IGAMA

ra

rah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘r’ — used mostly in words borrowed from other languages

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

R r — «ra»

ra · re · ri · ro · ru

In Xhosa words, R comes mostly as **RH**: a scratchy sound like ‘ch’ in Scottish “loch”.



RR IS FOR

irayisi

ee-rah-YEE-see

rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Rr Rr Rr Rr

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Ss Ss

NAME · IGAMA

sa

sah

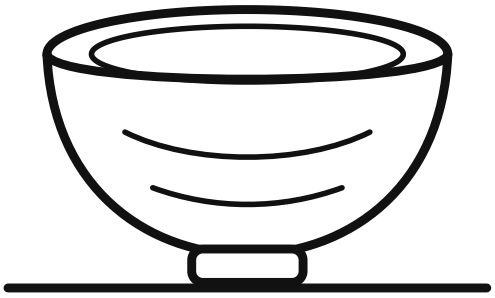
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

S s — «sa»

sa · se · si · so · su



SS IS FOR

isitya

ee-SEE-tyah

dish · bowl

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ss Ss Ss Ss

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Tt

NAME · IGAMA

ta

tah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

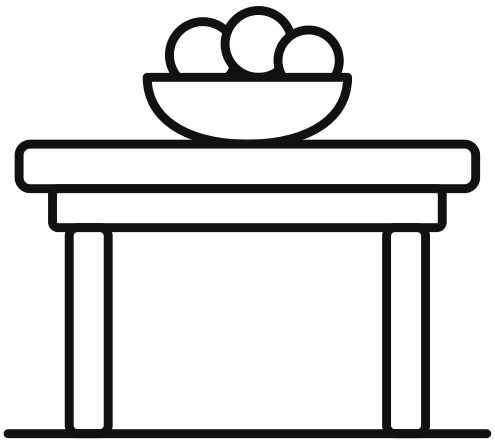
a soft ‘t’ (no puff of air)

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

T t — «ta»

ta · te · ti · to · tu

T is soft; **TH** is a ‘t’ with a puff of air — never the ‘th’ of “think”.



TT IS FOR

itafile

ee-tah-FEE-leh

table

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Tt Tt Tt Tt

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Uu

NAME · IGAMA

u

oo

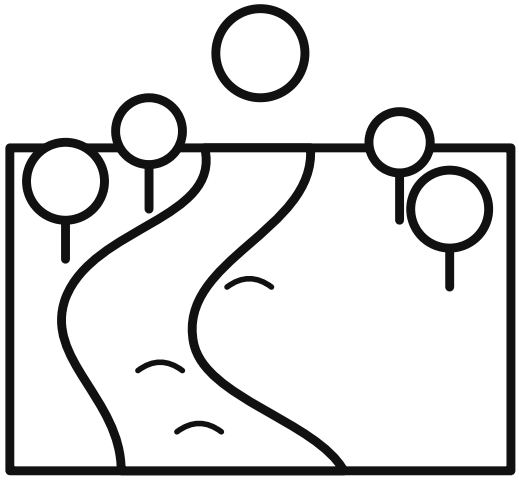
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

U u — «u»

bu · du · ku · lu · mu



UU IS FOR

umlambo

oom-LAHM-boh

river

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Uu Uu Uu Uu

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Vv

NAME · IGAMA

va

vah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘v’ as in “van”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

V v — «va»

va · ve · vi · vo · vu



VV **IS FOR**

imvula

eem-VOO-lah

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Vv Vv Vv Vv

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Ww

NAME · IGAMA

wa

wah

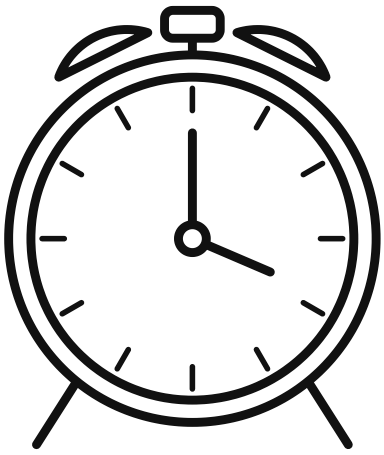
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘w’ as in “water”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

W w — «wa»

wa · we · wi · wo · wu



WW IS FOR

iwotshi

ee-WOH-tshee

watch · clock

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ww Ww Ww Ww

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Xx

NAME · IGAMA

xa

[x]ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

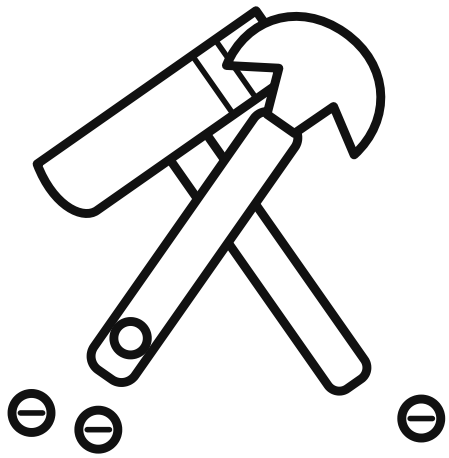
a **click**! Click the side of your tongue, like calling a horse

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

X x — «xa»

xa · xe · xi · xo · xu

The side click — the first sound of the word *Xhosa*! X is **never** ‘ks’ here.



XX **IS FOR**

isixhobo

ee-see-[x]OH-boh

tool

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Xx Xx Xx Xx

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Yy

NAME · IGAMA

ya

yah

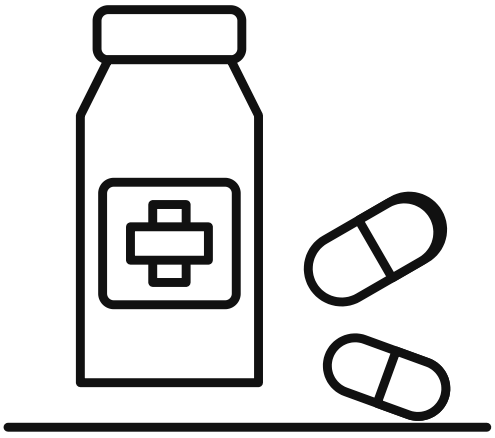
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Y y — «ya»

ya · ye · yi · yo · yu



YY IS FOR

iyeza

ee-YEH-zah

medicine

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Yy Yy Yy Yy

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Zz

NAME · IGAMA

za

zah

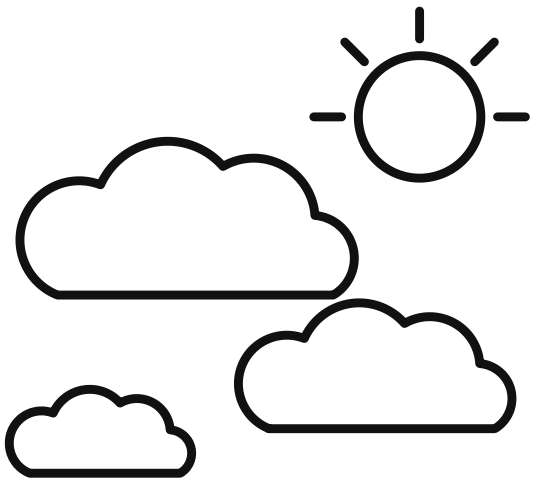
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Z z — «za»

za · ze · zi · zo · zu



ZZ IS FOR

izulu

ee-ZOO-loo

sky

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Zz Zz Zz Zz

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LETTER PAIRS

Letter Pairs bh · dl · hl · kh · ny · ph · th · ty

eight pairs that make one sound each

Many Xhosa sounds are written with **two letters**. Each pair is **one sound**.

A puff of air
An **H** after a letter often adds a puff of air: **KH PH TH**. So **PH** is never ‘f’ and **TH** is never the ‘th’ of “think”.

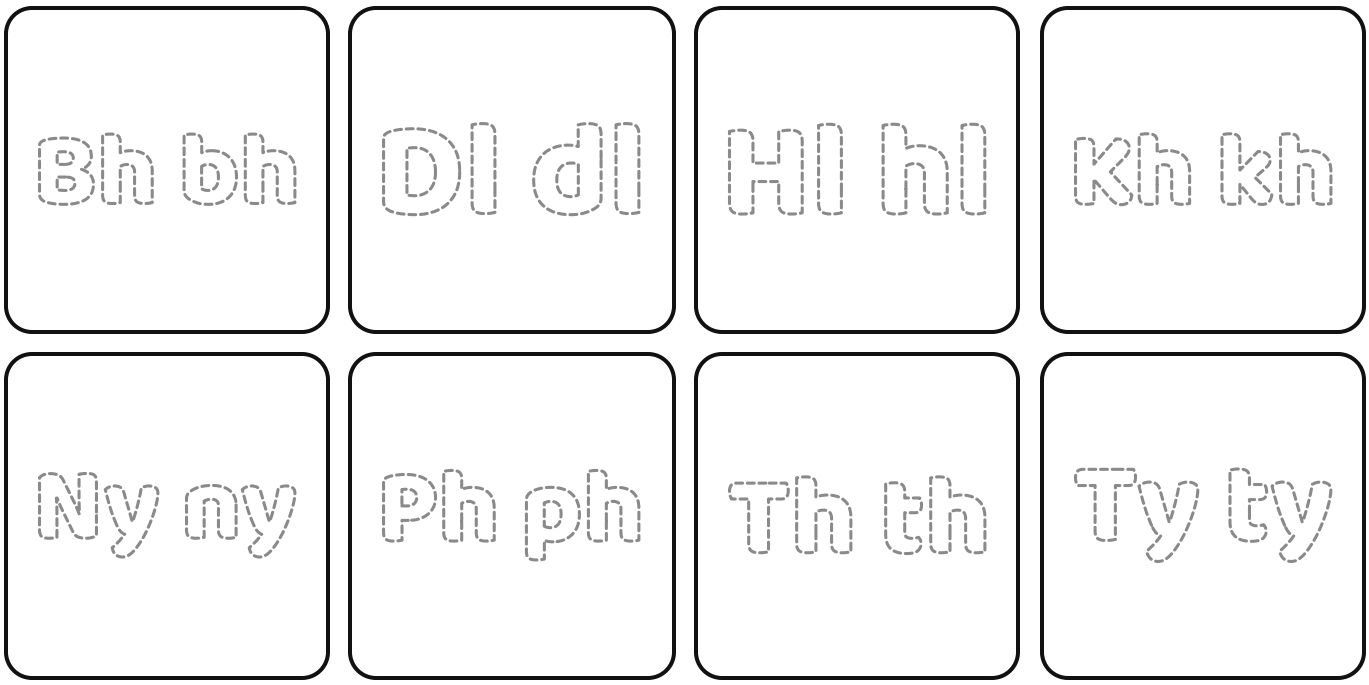
Two special sounds: HL and DL
HL is a hissing ‘l’ and **DL** a buzzing ‘l’: let the air slide past the sides of your tongue, as in *ihlathi* (forest) and *indlu* (house).

Clicks in pairs too
Clicks can team up with other letters: **gq**, **nq**, **xh**, **ngc**... Listen for them in *isiXhosa* itself!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letter pairs bh · dl · hl · kh · ny · ph · th · ty

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Bh bh

NAME · IGAMA

bha

bah

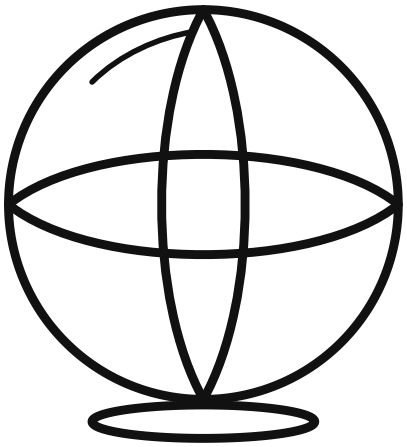
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Bh bh — «bha»

bha · bhe · bhi · bho · bhu



BH BH IS FOR

ibhola

ee-BOH-lah

ball

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Bh bh Bh bh Bh bh Bh bh

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Dl dl

NAME · IGAMA

dla

dlah

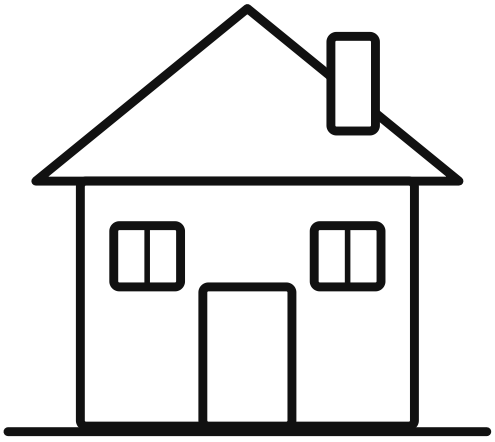
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a buzzing ‘l’: say ‘d’ and ‘l’ together, with air at the sides of the tongue

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Dl dl — «dla»

dla · dle · dli · dlo · dlu



DL DL IS FOR

indlu

EEN-dloo

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Dl dl Dl dl Dl dl Dl dl

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Hl hl

NAME · IGAMA

hla

hlah

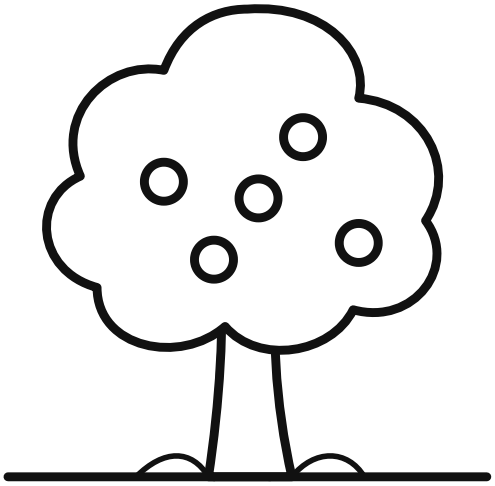
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hissing ‘l’: blow air past the sides of your tongue (like Welsh “ll”)

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Hl hl — «hla»

hla · hle · hli · hlo · hlu



HL HL IS FOR

ihlathi

ee-HLAH-tee

forest

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Hl hl Hl hl Hl hl Hl hl

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Kh kh

NAME · IGAMA

kha

kah

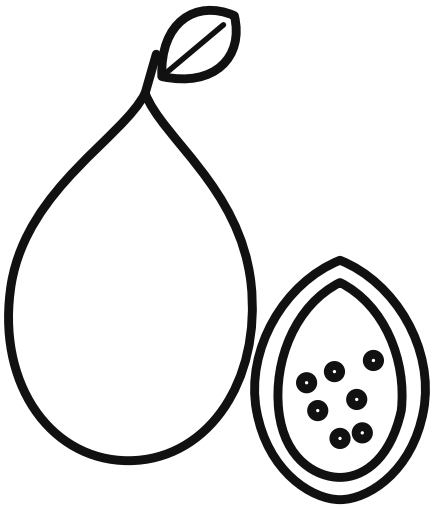
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ with a puff of air, as in “kite”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Kh kh — «kha»

kha · khe · khi · kho · khu



KH KH IS FOR

ikhiwane

ee-kee-WAH-neh

fig

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Kh kh Kh kh Kh kh Kh kh

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Ny ny

NAME · IGAMA

nya

nyah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ny’ as in “canyon”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Ny ny — «nya»

nya · nye · nyi · nyo · nyu



NY NY IS FOR

inyanga

ee-NYAHN-gah

moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny

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Ph ph

NAME · IGAMA

pha

pah

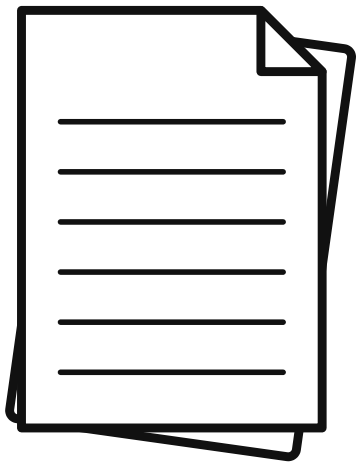
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ with a puff of air, as in “pen” — not ‘f’!

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Ph ph — «pha»

pha · phe · phi · pho · phu



PH PH IS FOR

iphepha

ee-PEH-pah

paper

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ph ph Ph ph Ph ph Ph ph

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Th th

NAME · IGAMA

tha

tah

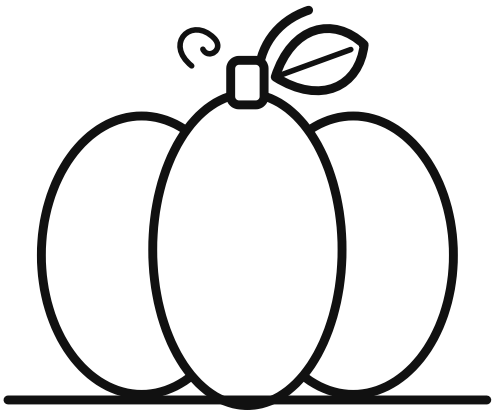
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ with a puff of air, as in “tap” — not ‘th’!

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Th th — «tha»

tha · the · thi · tho · thu



TH TH IS FOR

ithanga

ee-TAHN-gah

pumpkin

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Th th Th th Th th Th th

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Ty ty

NAME · IGAMA

tya

tyah

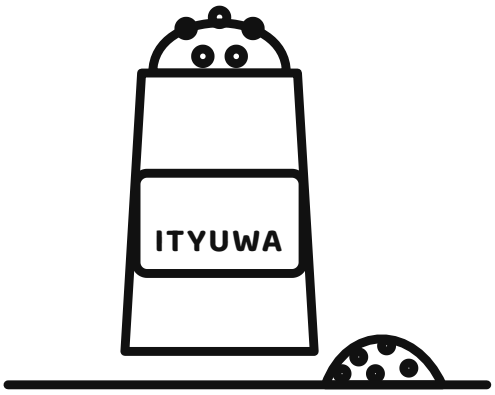
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a quick ‘t’ + ‘y’ said together, close to the ‘ch’ in “church”

XHOSA LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Ty ty — «tya»

tya · tye · tyi · tyo · tyu



TY TY IS FOR

ityuwa

ee-TYOO-wah

salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

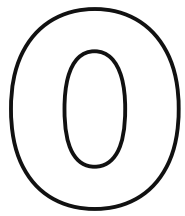
Ty ty Ty ty Ty ty Ty ty

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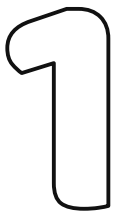
BONUS

Xhosa numbers amanani *(ah-mah-NAH-nee)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Xhosa: *ee-[q]AHN-dah*, *EE-nyeh*, *zeem-BEE-nee*, *zeen-TAH-too*...



0
iqanda
ee-[q]AHN-dah
zero



1
inye
EE-nyeh
one



2
zimbini
zeem-BEE-nee
two



3
zintathu
zeen-TAH-too
three



4
zine
ZEE-neh
four



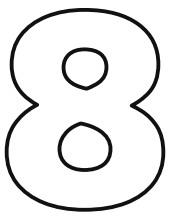
5
zintlanu
zeen-TLAH-noo
five



6
zintandathu
zeen-tahn-DAH-too
six



7
zisixhenxe
zee-see-[x]EN-[x]eh
seven



8
zisibhozo
zee-see-BOH-zoh
eight



9
zilithoba
zee-lee-TOH-bah
nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Xhosa words Amagama okuqala

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

Assalaamu alaykum
as-sah-LAH-moo ah-LAY-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

Wa alaykum assalaam
wah ah-LAY-koom as-sah-LAHM
And upon you be peace (the reply)

Molo!
MOH-loh
Hello! (to one person)

Igama lam ngu...
ee-GAH-mah lahm ngoo...
My name is ...

Enkosi
en-KOH-see
Thank you

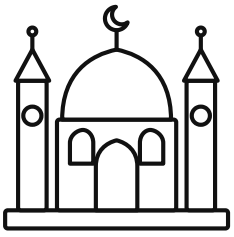
Jazaakallaahu khayran
jah-zaa-kal-LAA-hoo KHAY-ran
May Allah reward you with good

umama · utata
oo-MAH-mah · oo-TAH-tah
Mother · Father

ubhuti · usisi
oo-BOO-tee · oo-SEE-see
Brother · Sister

ewe · hayi
EH-weh · HAH-yee
Yes · No

Ndifunda isiXhosa!
ndee-FOON-dah ee-see-[x]OH-sah
I am learning Xhosa!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

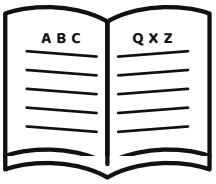
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

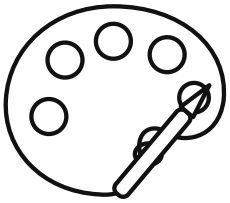
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International).

What's next?
You have met all **34 Xhosa letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Xhosa, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

Mashallah! Wenze kakuhle!

mah-SHAH-lah! WEN-zeh kah-KOO-hleh — Mashallah! Well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 34 letters of the Xhosa alphabet.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.